

9-4-26

Sujit class 1

Decision Theory: ch 12, 13

A brief intro

A pen is being sold at a shop for 200

What makes you decide to buy this pen?

Capture this for autonomous agent?

Techniques to take decisions in the face of uncertainty.

When faced with uncertainty (normal in any real world task), don't use ad-hoc techniques.

Decision theory provides well-developed techniques.

But, what is uncertainty, and why do we need to reason with it?

Which route to take?

Route 1: Sibiu $\rightarrow$ Fagaras $\rightarrow$ Bucharest : 310Route 2: Rimnicu $\rightarrow$ Pitesti $\rightarrow$ Bucharest 278

Ideally would take shortest route

What if traffic is a factor?

Suppose you have accurate info that -

R1 has fast moving traffic while

R2 has slow moving traffic.

A logical agent may reason

Slow(R2) fast(R1)

Slow(x) $\Rightarrow$ Avoid(x)

Avoid(x) $\wedge$ fast(y) $\Rightarrow$ select(y)

Agent selects R1

Do you think this is a good way to reason?

Why? Why not?

		Online	Delay	Time
R1	SFB	80% 4h	20% 10h	5.2h
R2	SRPB	70% 4.5h	30% 5h	<5h

80%

How much do you care
about uncertainty

Uncertainty:

May not have categorical answers

May not know exactly which route is slow

50% chance that one route is slow

Even if we know slow, how slow?

Changes the way agent takes decision

Probability theory used in helping agents reason with uncertainty

- Summarize uncertainty due to our ignorance or laziness
- may be very costly to remove such uncertainty

~~Decision Theory~~ (How to make

Rational decisions depend on
Relative importance of various goals
Likelihood or degree to which they
will be achieved

Decision Theory
(How to make decisions)

Decision Theory = ^(Deals with chance) Probability Theory +
^(Deals with outcomes) Utility Theory

Fundamental idea:

The MEU (Maximum expected utility)
principle

Agent is rational iff it chooses the
action that yields highest expected
utility averaged over possible outcomes
of the action

weigh the utility of each outcome by
the probability that it occurs.

Utility Theory: Von Neumann (Game
Theory)

Let X be the set of outcomes. $\succ$ be the preference of a player over the set of outcomes

Axioms:

- Completeness: every pair of outcomes is ranked
- Transitivity: If $x_1 \succ x_2$ & $x_2 \succ x_3$ then $x_1 \succ x_3$
- Substitutability: If $x_1 \sim x_2$ then any lottery in which x_1 is substituted by x_2 is equally preferred
- Decomposability: two different lotteries assign same probability to each outcome, then player is indifferent between these two lotteries
- Monotonicity: If $x_1 \succ x_2$ & $p > q$ then $[x_1: p, x_2: 1-p] \succ [x_1: q, x_2: 1-q]$
- Continuity: If $x_1 \succ x_2 \succ x_3$, $\exists p \in (0,1)$ such that $x_2 \sim [x_1: p, x_3: 1-p]$

Von Neumann & Morgenstern

Theorem:

Given a set of outcomes X & a preference relation on X that satisfies above six axioms, there exists a utility function $u: X \rightarrow [0,1]$ with the following properties:

$$1) u(x_1) \geq u(x_2) \text{ iff } x_1 \succ x_2$$

$$2) U([x_1:p_1; x_2:p_2; \dots; x_m:p_m]) \\ = \sum_{j=1}^m p_j u(x_j) \quad \sum p_j = 1$$

Basic Probability Notation

Probabilities over sample space of a variable - $P(X)$

Called the probability of distribution for random variable

Map of sample space to real numbers

$$P(\text{Weather} = \text{sunny}) = 0.6$$

$$P(\text{Weather} = \text{rain}) = 0.1$$

$$P(\text{Weather} = \text{cloudy}) = 0.29$$

$$P(\text{Weather} = \text{snow}) = 0.01$$

$$P(\text{Weather}) = \langle 0.6, 0.1, 0.29, 0.01 \rangle$$

$$\sum P(X = x_i) = 1$$

$$x_i \in \{\text{sunny}, \text{rain}, \text{cloudy}, \text{snow}\}$$

Conditional Probability (Posterior)

$$A, B \quad P(A|B) = \frac{P(A \cap B)}{P(B)} \quad \text{if } P(B) > 0$$

$\cdot n$

$$K_1 \rightarrow B$$

$$K \rightarrow A \cap B$$

$$k_1/k = \frac{k_1/n}{K/n} = \frac{P(A \cap B)}{P(B)}$$



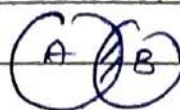
$P(X = \text{Sunny} \mid \text{last 2 days were sunny})$
If we know B & C, $P(A \mid B \cap C)$

Product Rule:

$$P(A \mid B) = P(A \cap B) / P(B)$$

$$P(A \cap B) = P(A \mid B) P(B)$$

$$P(A \cap B) = P(B \mid A) P(A)$$



Toothache $\rightarrow$ Cavity

Cavity $\rightarrow$ toothache?

Joint Probability Distribution

Notation for distributions on multiple variables

$P(\text{Weather} \rightarrow \text{cavity})$ i.e. $P(\text{Weather} \cap \text{cavity})$

Joint PD is a table:

Assigns prob to all possible assignment of values for combinations of variables

Weather has values (Sunny, R, C, snow)

Cavity has values (T, F)

4×2 table of prob.

Inference using full joint distribution

3 var: {Cavity, toothache, Catch}

$2 \times 2 \times 2$ table

Dentist catches or not

$P(x_1, x_2, \dots, x_n)$ probs to all possible assignment of values to variables $x_1, x_2, \dots, x_n$

	toothache			
	ache	noache	catch	no catch
cavity	.108	.012	.072	.008
no cav	.016	.064	.144	.576

$$P(\text{cavity}) = 0.2 = 0.108 + 0.012 + 0.072 + 0.008$$

Marginal prob of cavity

$$P(X=x) = \sum_{(y,z)} P(X=x, Y=y, Z=z)$$

Marginalization

$$P(\text{cavity} | \text{toothache}) = \frac{0.108 + 0.012}{0.2} = 0.6$$

$$P(\text{no cavity} | \text{toothache}) = 0.4$$

$$= P(\text{no cav} \wedge \text{toothache}) / P(\text{ache})$$

$$P(\text{cavity} | \text{ache}) + P(\text{no cav} | \text{ache}) = 1$$

Denominator can be viewed as normalization constant $1/P(\text{toothache})$

$$P(\text{cav} | \text{ache}) \propto P(\text{cav}, \text{ache})$$

$$= \propto [P(\text{cav}, \text{ache}, \text{catch}) + P(\text{cav}, \text{ache}, \text{no catch})]$$

$$= \propto 0.12$$

$$\propto P(\neg \text{cav}, \text{toothache}) : \propto [0.016 + 0.064] \\ = \propto 0.08$$

Normalizing $\propto \langle 0.12, 0.08 \rangle$ gives $\langle 0.6, 0.4 \rangle$

Issue: For domain with n Boolean var,
input table size $O(2^n)$

Full joint dis in tabular form not a practical
tool for building reasoning systems.

Independence:

Helps in reducing size of domain representation
& complexity of inference problem.

Let's add weather into example: Sun, r, c,
Snowy - $2 \times 2 \times 2 \times 4$ entries in table

$$P(\text{ache}, \text{catch}, \text{cav}, \text{cloudy}) = P(\text{cloudy} | \\ \text{toothache}, \text{catch}, \text{cav}) P(\text{ache}, \text{catch}, \text{cav})$$

$$P(\text{cloudy} | \text{ache}, \text{catch}, \text{cav}) = P(\text{cloudy})$$

8 elements table becomes 2 elements +
4 elements table

$$P(A \wedge B) = P(A)P(B)$$

$$P(A | B) = P(A)$$

Bayes's Rule:

Given that

$$P(A \cap B) = P(A|B) P(B)$$

$$P(A \cap B) = P(B|A) P(A)$$

$$P(B|A) = \frac{P(A|B) P(B)}{P(A)}$$

$P(\text{effect} | \text{cause})$ $P(A|B)$ causal knowledge

$P(\text{cause} | \text{effect})$ $P(B|A)$ diagnostic knowledge

Often have word prob or casual relationships

→ $P(\text{Symptoms} | \text{disease})$

Need to infer diagnostic knowledge many times.

Sujit class 2

12-4-25

Bayes' Rule.

$$P(B|A) = \frac{P(A|B) P(B)}{P(A)} \rightarrow \text{Prior}$$

Likelihood / Causal

↓

Posterior Evidence

Diagnostic

Bayes' Rule Example:

S: Proposition that patient has stiff neck

M: Prop that he has meningitis

M causes S 70% of time

Given

$$P(S|M) = 0.7$$

$$P(M) = 1/50,000$$

$$P(S) = 0.01$$

$$P(M|S) = 0.0014 = P(S|M)P(M)/P(S)$$

Why so low?

Bayes Rule use:

Why not estimate $P(M|S)$ the same way we do $P(S|M)$?

Why do we need Bayes Rule?

$P(S|M)$ is causal knowledge "does not change"

It is "model based"

It reflects the way meningitis works

$P(M|S)$ is diagnostic, tells likelihood of M given symptoms

Diagnostic knowledge may change with circumstance, thus helpful to derive it

If there is an epidemic, prob of menin goes up, rather than trying to estimate $P(M|S)$ which is very hard, we can compute it using other terms
However, $P(S|M)$ is unaffected by the epidemic

Use of causal or model based knowledge provides crucial robustness for probabilistic systems.

Computing the Denominator $P(S)$

We wish to avoid computing the denominator in Bayes rule

May be hard to obtain

In our example, denom is $P(S)$

Techniques to compute (avoid computing $P(S)$)

Our first approach is to compute relative likelihoods

If M (menor) & W (whiplash) are 2 possible explanations:

$$P(M|S) = P(S|M) P(M) / P(S)$$

$$P(W|S) = P(S|W) P(W) / P(S)$$

$$P(M|S) / P(W|S) = P(S|M) P(M) / P(S|W) P(W)$$

Computing the denominator $P(S)$

Another approach Approach 2

$$P(M|S) = P(S|M) P(M) / P(S)$$

$$P(\text{NOT}(M)|S) = P(S|\text{NOT}(M))$$

$$P(\text{NOT}(M)) / P(S)$$

$$P(M|S) + P(\text{NOT}(M)|S) = 1$$

(They must sum to 1)

$$[P(S|M)P(M)/P(S)] + [P(S|\text{NOT}(M)) * P(\text{NOT}(M))/P(S)] = 1$$

$$P(S|M) * P(M) + P(S|\text{NOT}(M)) * P(\text{NOT}(M)) = P(S)$$

calculate $P(S)$ in this way

Simple Example

Suppose 2 identical urns

URN1 colored red from inside has $1/3$ black $2/3$ red balls

URN2 colored black from inside $1/3$ red $2/3$ black balls

We select 1 urn at random, can't tell how its colored inside

What is the probability that urn is colored red inside 0.5

What if we were to select ball at random from the urn & its red? Does that change the probability?

Apply Bayes Rule

$$P(\text{Red urn} | \text{Red ball}) = P(\text{RB} | \text{RU}) * P(\text{RU}) / P(\text{RB}) = \frac{2 \times 0.5}{3} / P(\text{red ball})$$

How to calculate $P(\text{red ball})$?

$$P(\text{BU} | \text{RB}) = P(\text{RB} | \text{BU}) * P(\text{BU}) / P(\text{RB}) = \frac{1/3 * 0.5}{P(\text{RB})}$$

$$P(\text{RB}) = 0$$

By approach #2 $\frac{2}{3} (0.5) / P(RB)$

$$+ \frac{1}{3} 0.5 / P(RB) = 1$$

$$P(RB) = 0.5$$

$$\therefore P(RB) + P(RU|RB) = 2/3$$

More general forms of Bayes Rule

$$P(Y|X) = P(X|Y) * P(Y) / P(X)$$

Bayes rule for multi-valued variables
Generalize to background evidence e
Same

$$P(Y|X, e) = P(X|Y, e) * P(Y|e) / P(X|e)$$

Conditional Independence

Toothache & catch are independent given presence of cavity

Each is directly caused by cavity,
toothache is caused by cavity & dentist
catches cavity using probe

A toothache can't be caught by a
probe nor a probe results in a toothache

Conditional Independence captured as

$$P(\text{TN} | \text{cat, cav}) = P(A|B, C)$$

$$P(A|B \cap C) = P(A|B)$$

$$\therefore P(TA, \text{Catch} | \text{cav}) = \frac{P(TA | \text{cav}) \cdot P(\text{Catch} | \text{cav})}{P(\text{Catch} | \text{cav})}$$

Combining Evidence

Revisiting Meningitis example

S: Prop that patient has stiff neck

His Prop that pat has severe headache

M : Prop u u u mener

in cases 9, 50% of time

m causes H, 70% of time

Prob of menes should go up if both symptoms reported - how to combine such symptoms?

$$P(A|B \cap C) = P(A \cap B \cap C) / P(B \cap C)$$

Numerators

$$P(M \wedge S \wedge H) = P(S|M \wedge H) P(M \wedge H) \\ = P(S|M) P(M \wedge H)$$

Why?

$$= P(S|M) P(H|M) P(M)$$

Going back to our example

$$P(M|S \wedge H) = \frac{P(S|M) P(H|M) * P(M)}{P(S \wedge H)}$$

S & H are cond ind

Decision Theory

Revisiting Romania example

If P_1 & P_2 are two plans

P_1 uses R_1

$$P(\text{home-early} | P_1) = 0.8$$

$$P(\text{stuck} | P_1) = 0.2$$

R_1 is quick if flowing but stuck for 1 hour if slow

$$U(\text{home-early}) = 100$$

$$U(\text{stuck}) = -1000$$

Assigned numerical values to outcomes

P_2 uses R_2

$$P(\text{home somewhat early} | P_2) = 0.7$$

$$P(\text{stuck 2} | P_2) = 0.3$$

R2 will be somewhat quick if flowing but not bad even if slow

$$U(\text{home somewhat early}) = 50$$

$$U(\text{stuck 2}) = -10$$

Application of MEU example

$$EU(P_1) = P(\text{home early} | P_1) P U(\text{home early}) + P(\text{stuck 1} | P_1) U(\text{stuck 1})$$

$$= 0.8 * 100 + 0.2(-1000) = -120$$

$$EU(P_2) = P(\text{home somewhat early} | P_2) U(\text{home somewhat early}) + P(\text{stuck 2} | P_2) U(\text{stuck 2})$$

$$= 0.7(50) + 0.3(-10) = 32$$

Risk aversion

We are risk averse

Our utility functions for money are as follows:

First million means a lot (US \$1M) = 10

Sec mil' not so much

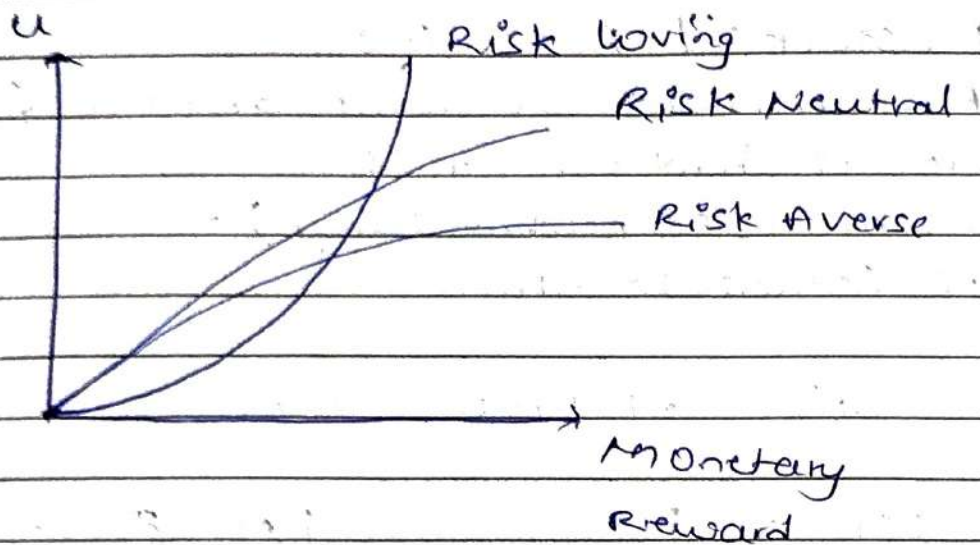
= 15

(NOT 20)

Third mil even less so

= 18 (NOT

30)



Additional money not buying as much utility

If we plot amt of money on x & utility on y we get concave curve

Risk Averse, Risk Neutral, risk seeking

More Risk Aversion

Key: Slope of utility function is continuously decreasing

we will refuse to play a monetarily fair bet

Suppose we start with x dollars

we are offered a game

0.5 chance to win 1000 dollar

($C = 1000$)

0.5 to lose 1k ($C = 1K$)

Expected monetary gain/loss is 0

(hence manifestly fair)

Should be neutral to it, but seems we are not. Why?

$$U(x+c) - U(x) < U(x) - U(x-c)$$

$$U(x+c) + U(x-c) < 2U(x)$$

$$\{U(x+c) + U(x-c)\} / 2 < U(x)$$

EU: (playing game) < EU (not playing game)

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Recap Bayes Theorem

Conditional Independence

Utility Theory:

- Risk averse

- concave

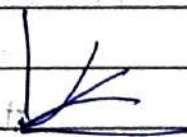
- Risk Neutral

- straight

- Risk seeking / loving

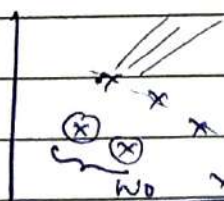
- convex

MEU:



Pareto Efficient

If there is no other better outcome



} all 3 are PE

will also become PE if its below the 4.

Weighted

w_1	H_1	x_1	$\sum w_i EU_i$
w_2	H_2	x_2	Pareto Efficient
$\vdots$	$\vdots$	$\vdots$	
w_n		x_n	

Option x is pareto eff if $\nexists$ no out come y for which on all ~~oth~~ aspects, y is better.

Pareto efficient:

Suppose we are dealing with N -dimensional utilities. Option x is pareto efficient if $\nexists y$ st $U_i(y) \geq U_i(x)$ $i=1, \dots, N$ with strict inequality for atleast one i .

A	Production	Marketing	A = action space
a_0	+	+	
a_1	+	-	
a_2	-	+	
a_3	-	-	→ No change

State: Modeling inventory
 $S = \{L, M, H\}$

(L)

(M)

(H)

Transition Probability

$P: S \times S \times A \rightarrow [0, 1]$
 current $\times$ future $\times$ action

Reward $R: S \times S \times A \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$

current $\times$ destination / future state $\times$ action.

$P_a(s, s')$: Probability of system moving from state s to s' if we take action a

$R_a(s, s')$: The reward that we obtain if we take an action a in state s & reach state s'

$\langle S, A, R, P \rangle$ tuple is called MDP
Markov Decision Process.

Markov Decision Process :

Based on current state only, not previous state.

Example: What sequence of actions can agent take?

Agent can take action N, E, S, W

Each action costs $-\frac{1}{25}$

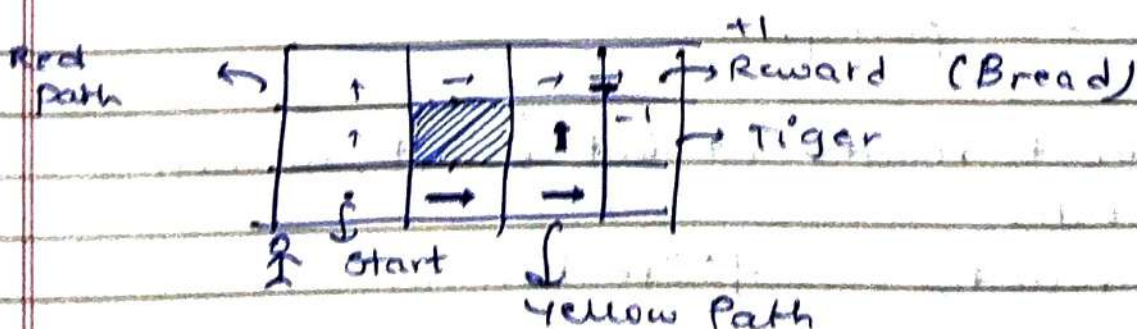
Possible states

$(1, 3)$ $(1, 2)$ $(1, 1)$

$(2, 3)$ $(2, 1)$

$(3, 3)$ $(3, 2)$ $(3, 1)$

$(4, 1)$ $(4, 2)$ $(4, 3)$



Have to consider all future paths in utility
Simple search algo? Not deterministic

Red: N, N, E, E, E

Yellow: E E N N E

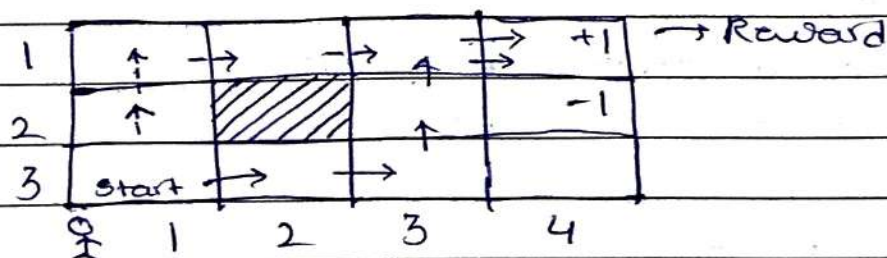
Have to consider state transitions. In each state decide & compare action.

Deterministic Policy :

$$\pi : S \rightarrow A$$

Randomized Policy to take actions:

$$\pi : S \rightarrow \Delta(A)$$



For MDP we can argue that no randomized policy performs better than optimum deterministic policy.

After t rounds we don't revert, no more states

T rounds finite horizon

If you interact infinitely many times $\rightarrow$
infinite horizon

At $T=0$ I use π^0 policy

$T=1$

π^1

$T=2$

π^2

If I use the same policy for all ~~as~~
rounds - stationary policy

$$\pi^0 = \pi^1 = \pi^2 = \dots$$

$|A|^{|S|}$ = # of policies possible for each
round (each policy for all states)

For MDP, deterministic & stationary
policy works.

Say I have 2 states (0) (1) actions

a_0, a_1

eg:

$$\pi_0 = (0, a_0) (1, a_1)$$

$$\pi_1 = (0, a_1) (1, a_1)$$

$$\pi_2 = (0, a_1) (1, a_0)$$

$$\pi_3 = (0, a_0) (1, a_0)$$

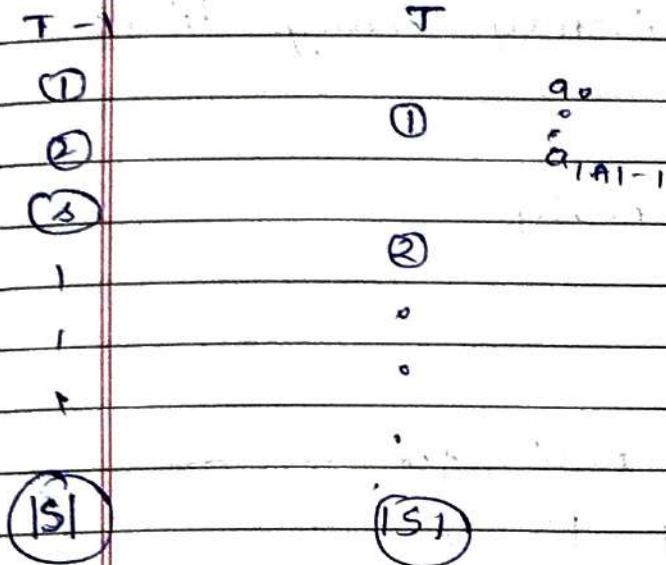
4 policies.

Focus on det., sta.

Finite horizon:

No more rewards or game over after

T rounds.



$$\sum_{s \in S} P_a(l, s) \times R_a(l, s)$$

$$\sum_{s \in S} P_{a_1}(l, s) \times R_{a_1}(l, s)$$

$$V^T(s) = \max_{a \in A} \sum_{s' \in S} P_a(s, s') R_a(s, s')$$

$$\pi^T(s) = \operatorname{argmax}_{a \in A} \sum_{s' \in S} P_a(s, s') R_a(s, s')$$

Suppose now you're in second best round in state s

$$V^{T-1}(s, a) = \sum_{s' \in S} P_a(s, s') [V^T(s') + R_a(s, s')]$$

$$V^{T-1}(s) = \max_a V^{T-1}(s, a)$$

Inductively we can define

$$V^{T-K}(s) = \max_a$$

$$\left[\sum_{s' \in S} P_a(s, s') \{ V^{T-K+1}(s') + R_a(s, s') \} \right]$$

Will this work if we have ∞ horizon?

(0)

a_0, a_1

(1)

$$\pi(0) = a_0 \quad P_{a_0}(0, 1) = 0.6 = P_{a_1}(1, 0)$$

$$\pi(1) = a_1 \quad P_{a_0}(0, 0) = 0.4 = P_{a_1}(1, 1)$$

For simplicity

$$R_{a_0}(0, 1) = R_{a_0}(0, 0)$$

$$R_{a_1}(1, 0) = R_{a_1}(1, 1) = 1$$

At some point

$$V(0) = 2$$

$$V(1) = 3$$

According to this policy, we update

$$V^\pi(0) = 0.4 [1 + \overset{V(0)}{2}] + 0.6 [1 + \overset{V(1)}{3}]$$

$$= 3.6$$

$$\begin{aligned}
 & V_1 \text{ estimate:} \quad \overset{V(1)}{\nearrow} \quad \overset{V(0)}{\nearrow} \\
 V^{\pi}(1) &= 0.4 [1+3] + 0.6 [1+3.6] \\
 &= 1.6 + 4.36
 \end{aligned}$$

As you keep play, assigning infinite rewards to states. Not easy to compare infinite rewards.

Say:

5, 5, 5, 5, 0, 5, 5, 5, 5, 5, 0, ...
4, 4, 4, 4, 4, 4, 4, ...

Are both equal?

Sum is ∞ in both cases? How to compare

0, 0, 0, 0, 0, 5, 5, 5, 5, 0, ...
4, 4, 4, 4, 4, 4, 4, ...

What about this?

Depends. Initially better vs initially worse.

We discount future by γ

usually $0 < \gamma < 1$

How much you value future rewards today.

$$V^{\pi}(0) = 0.4 [1 + \gamma 2] + 0.6 [1 + \gamma 3]$$

$$V^{\pi}(1) = 0.4 [1 + \gamma 3] + 0.6 [1 + \gamma 4]$$

With that:

$$V(s) = \max_a \sum_{s' \in S} P_a(s, s') \times \left\{ R_a(s, s') + \gamma V(s') \right\}$$

↓
Discount factor.

Two ways:

Value iteration:

$$V^{t+1}(s) = \dots V^t(s)$$

as $t \rightarrow \infty$

$$\|V^{t+1}(s) - V^t(s)\|_2 \rightarrow 0$$

As long as $\gamma < 1$, values will be fine & algorithm will converge.

Policy iteration value:

Look at policy rather than value.

Practically, we may not always know what the rewards are & transitions probabilities may not be known.

Using Monte Carlo methods, if we know

the transition prob., not reward, do a large number of simulations to determine policy.

But may not know both. Maintaining a Q-Learning table based on SARSA

May sometimes be unstable, slight changes in rewards change policy.

Then:

Double Q methods where one table updates slower than the other

DQN

Double DQN.

DPFG, popular neural network based algo.

Used to train AlphaZero.

Bellman backward induction?

<SARSA> must be known for this & for value iteration. (for our case)

Next class Multi-arm bandit.

Short class 30-40min

Early attendance.

Sujit class 3

Recap:

Markov Decision Process (MDP)

 S, A, R, P finite Horizon MDP Use MCV $v^T(s)$ $v^T(s)$ $v^T(s)$

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$$v^{T-1}(s, a) = R$$

$$\sum_{s'} \{ R_a(s, s') + \gamma v^T(s') \} P_a(s, s')$$

Bellman Backward Induction.

Multiply by discount factor.

$$v^{t+1}(s) = \max_a \sum_{s'} P_a(s, s') \{ R_a(s, s') + \gamma v^t(s') \}$$

One special case of this becomes

$$|s| = 1$$

$$\pi^*(s) = \arg \max_a R_a(s, s)$$

$$R_a = 1 \quad \text{w.p. } \mu_a \quad \text{w.p. = with prob}$$

$$= 0 \quad \text{otherwise}$$

$$a^* = \operatorname{argmax} \mu_a$$

What if you don't know μ_a

Multi-armed Bandits (MAB)

K actions

Greedy Approach

for $i = 1 \rightarrow m/k$

use action i

Observe R_i

update $\hat{\mu}_i$

} Exploration

for $i = mk + 1 \rightarrow T$

use action $i^* = \operatorname{argmax} \hat{\mu}_i$

update $\hat{\mu}_{i^*}$

} Exploitation

Say I take actions in RR fashion.

$m = 1$

Issue: Suppose 2 actions

$$\mu_1 = 0.9$$

$$\mu_2 = 0.8$$

Probability of reward = 0.1

with prob 0.8

$$\hat{\mu}_1 = 0 \quad \hat{\mu}_2 = 1$$

$$\text{If } m = T/k$$

Half the round

$$\left\{ \frac{0.1 \times T}{2} \right\} \text{ loss on average}$$

m should not be too large or small

an MAB, balance explo - ration / itation.

$m = 1$ called ϵ_t Greedy Algorithm

Exploitation

w.p. $(1 - \epsilon)$ Use greedy strategy

w.p. ϵ select an action randomly

(w.p. $1/k$)

How to set ϵ ?

If very large - almost on average m to be order T .

Most time spent ~~to~~ exploration. Good learning

ϵ too small - no good learning - use second or third best arm.

Instead use

$$\epsilon_t = O\left(\frac{1}{t}\right)$$

Order $(1/t)$

As time $\uparrow$, $\epsilon \downarrow$

ϵ can also be called learning rate.

Initially learn, then learn less & exploit

To compare algorithms:

Regret (Finite Horizon)

$$\sum_{t=1}^T \mu_{a^*} - \mu_{a_t}$$

Info theoretic Lower bound.

No algo can do better than:

Regret has to be atleast

$\Omega(\log T)$ lower bound

Upper Confidence Bound (UCB)

Regret very close to $\Omega(\log T)$

$\log T (\sqrt{\log T})?$

Algorithm:

for $i = 1 \rightarrow k$

use (pull arm) action i

Update $\hat{\mu}_i^t$

for $t = k+1 \rightarrow T$

pull $i^t = \arg \max_i \hat{\mu}_i^t + \sqrt{\frac{2 \log t}{N_{i,t}}}$

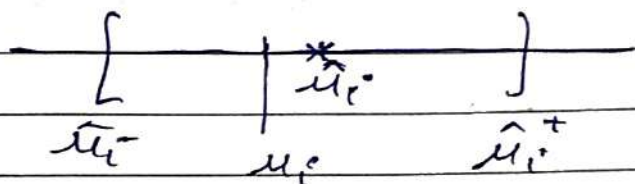
UCB

$N_{i^t, t+1} = N_{i^t, t} + 1$

Can also be written as $\hat{\mu}_i^t + \sqrt{\frac{2 \log t}{N_{i,t}}}$

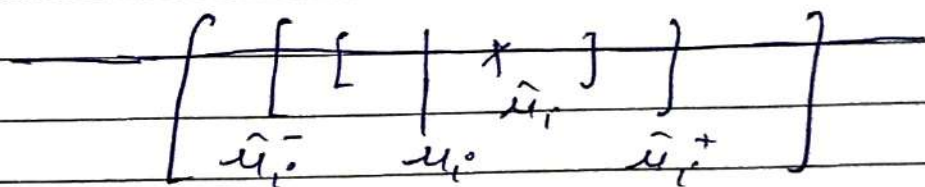
$N_{i,t}$:= # of times action/arm i is used till time t .

Intuitively



We can argue that suboptimal arm happened only $\log T$ times

$$\mu_a^* a^t \neq a^* + O(\log T)$$



$$|\hat{\mu}_{i,t}^+ - \mu_i^*| \quad |\hat{\mu}_{i,t}^+ - \hat{\mu}_i^-| ?$$

Agree for each arm

So Regret $(k-1) \log T$

For optimal arm $N_{i,t}$ increases linearly(?)
 $\log T$

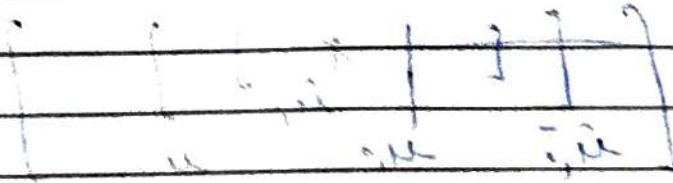
Q-learning - special case of Q-learning
Q tables

$$Q(s_t, a_t) = R_{a_t}(s_t, s_{t+1}) + \max_a Q(s_{t+1}, a)$$

Update 4:

$$\underline{u_{i+1}^t = u_i^t \times N_{gt} + R_i^t}$$

$$(17 \times 2) + 1 = 35$$



11

1. The first part of the text is a list of names and dates, including "T. B. (1881) 1890" and "T. B. (1881) 1890".

Lernitipps